Pharmacology – RAG Test Document

1. Aspirin

Aspirin inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes COX-1 and COX-2. This reduces the synthesis of prostaglandins and thromboxanes.

Low-dose aspirin irreversibly inhibits COX-1 in platelets. This reduces thromboxane A2 production and decreases platelet aggregation.

2. Paracetamol

Paracetamol is an analgesic and antipyretic medication. It helps relieve pain and reduce fever. It has relatively weak peripheral anti-inflammatory activity.

3. Important comparison

Aspirin has antiplatelet activity because it irreversibly inhibits platelet COX-1. Paracetamol does not have the same clinically significant antiplatelet effect.